



## Clinical Case Quiz



A 36 year-old male has had episodic headaches occurring only on the right side of his head and around the right eye for the past few days. The headaches are stabbing and sharp and last about an hour per episode. He has had 4 or 5 episodes a day. Along with the headache he has nasal congestion and eye tearing on the right side. He reports having these similar symptoms 3 months ago.

- ☐ A Sumatriptan
- ☐ B Acetaminophen
- ☐ C Ibuprofen
- ☐ D Oxygen therapy
- ☐ E Two of these answers are correct

The answer is E. Both A and D are the best treatment options here. The case describes a cluster headache which are **always** unilateral and oftentimes are associated with unilateral tearing and nasal congestion.

The best treatment for an acute cluster headache can include 100% oxygen via a nonrebreathing facial mask given at a rate of at least 12L/minute for fifteen minutes. Cluster headaches occur in “clusters” and patients often experience remission of symptoms for at least three months at a time.

Triptans have also been found to abort acute cluster headaches.

## Things to Be Mindful of When Providing Virtual Care

- If you encounter a member who requires stat labs or imaging, then do not order this during your encounter. Direct them to the closest urgent care or emergency department for further evaluation.
- Avoid prescribing controlled medications over our virtual platforms. This includes codeine cough syrup and opiate narcotic pain medications.
- When ordering testing for sexually transmitted diseases, avoid ordering a herpes serology as it is not always diagnostic of herpes. Oral, rectal, urethral, and vaginal swabs can be ordered virtually and completed in a local lab to rule out the most common STDs. Lab confirmation of herpes infections will need clinic appointment for proper lab specimen collection.